

Buyers Are Liars.

Read the picture. Give them a soft way out.

Session 29 · Monday 9 June 2026 · Marketing Sweet

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01 · KNOW THE NUMBER

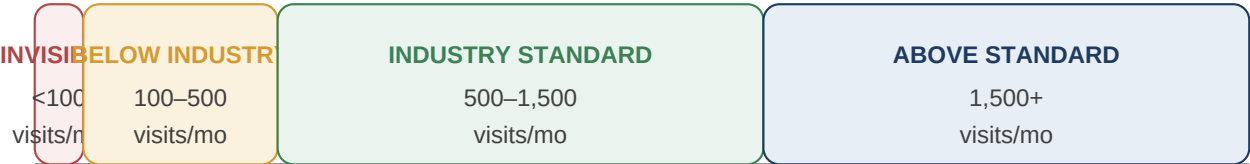
The 500–1,500 Rule

Industry standard organic traffic for a trade business.



90% OF YOUR PROSPECT LIST
lives below industry standard

MONTHLY ORGANIC TRAFFIC — TRADE BUSINESSES



WHY THIS MATTERS

Knowing the benchmark turns every call into a diagnostic. "Industry standard for trades is 500 to 1,500 a month — you're at 50. Worth 10 minutes to look at why?" The number does the work. The rep just narrates.

THE DEFAULT ASSUMPTION

Assume the campaign is BELOW industry standard until the data proves otherwise. That's where 90% of the market sits.

02 · THE DIAGNOSTIC

Branded vs Non-Branded

The 30-second test that exposes weak SEO.

WORKED EXAMPLE · 50 VISITS/MONTH

People typing the business NAME — would have found them anyway

DIAGNOSIS: The buyer is paying for SEO. The SEO is not earning the traffic. Brand is.

THE LINE — SAY IT CALMLY

"You've got 50 visits, and 49 of them are people typing your brand name straight in. You're paying for SEO, but your reputation is doing the earning — not your campaign. Worth 10 minutes to look at?"

RULE OF THUMB

If non-branded traffic is under 20% of the total, SEO is decorative — the buyer is paying for traffic they were going to get for free.

03 · THE FRAME

Soft Way In · Soft Way Out

Never call the buyer a liar. Let the data do it for you.

SOFT WAY IN

RAISING THE UNCOMFORTABLE DATA

- ◆ *"Look, I'm just a bit confused — my software is showing 50 visits. Doesn't quite make sense if you're doing SEO. Can you help me understand?"*
- ◆ *"This looks like a really light campaign. Would I be right saying \$100 to \$200 a month? Just trying to make sense of what I'm seeing."*
- ◆ *"Maybe my software's wrong — mind opening an incognito window and checking where you rank?"*

SOFT WAY OUT

LETTING THE BUYER ABANDON THEIR LIE

- ◆ *"Would you consider a second opinion? No pressure — even if you don't go with us, you'd have something to take to your current provider."*
- ◆ *"Let me just send you a screenshot. Look at it on your own time. Come back if you want to."*
- ◆ *"Whether you go with us or someone else — this account isn't going anywhere right now. Worth 10 minutes together?"*

THE PRINCIPLE

The buyer doesn't have to admit they were lying. The rep doesn't have to declare it. Both keep their dignity. Both can keep talking.

04 · THE CLOSE LINE

"We Need to Catch Up"

Borrow the grammar of running into a friend on the street.

THE LINE — SAY IT WARMLY

"Hey, we need to catch up."

Follow immediately with: "I've got something I think you'll really find interesting. Just 5 to 10 minutes."

WHY IT WORKS**It borrows familiar social grammar.**

"We need to catch up" is what people say to friends — friendly, low-pressure, almost impossible to refuse without seeming rude.

It bypasses the defensive script.

The buyer's brain has prepared answers for "can I book a meeting?" — it hasn't prepared one for this.

It implies a small, casual thing.

Not a sales pitch. Not an obligation. Just a catch-up.

It pairs perfectly with 5–10 minutes.

Friend catch-ups are short. The brevity matches the framing.

TWO INGREDIENTS · ENERGY + BREVITY

ENERGY: Say it warmly and confidently — like you mean it. Flat delivery makes it sound rehearsed; sales-y delivery breaks the spell.

BREVITY: Pair it immediately with "just 5 to 10 minutes — I think you're going to find this useful." The low time commitment is the second half of the move.

05 · TIME IS THE COST

The 50¢ Painting

Price your meeting ask in the right currency.

DON'T

"Can I get half an hour with you?"

= \$5,000

Stranger asking for big money on a cold call. Buyer's answer: no.

DO

"Just 5 to 10 minutes. I think you'll love this."

= 50¢

Pocket change. Buyer's answer: sure, whatever.

THE PAINTING PRINCIPLE

"It's a \$5,000 painting for 50¢." The meeting (the painting) needs to feel like it's worth far more than the time being asked for. High perceived value. Low time cost. Easy yes.

THE LINE THAT SELLS THE PAINTING

"I think you're going to love this." Said with real conviction. It's not a sales line — it's a sincere claim about the value of what you're about to show.

CORIE

"Treat half an hour as \$5,000. Treat five minutes as 50¢. When you ask, ask in the right currency. People will pay 50¢ for a painting they're curious about. They won't pay \$5,000 for one they've never seen."

REFERENCE

Daily Card · Keep By the Phone

The whole session on one page.

KNOW THE NUMBER

- ◆ Trades: 500–1,500 visits/month is industry standard.
- ◆ Anything under 500 is below standard — your booking opportunity.
- ◆ Default assumption: campaign is below standard until proven otherwise.

THE LIE DETECTOR

- ◆ Check the branded / non-branded split before the call.
- ◆ If <20% non-branded, the SEO is decorative. The brand is doing the work.
- ◆ Use the calibrated price range: "\$100 to \$200, would that be about right?"

THE SOFT MOVES

- ◆ Soft way in: "My software might be wrong — can you check?"
- ◆ Soft way out: "Whether you go with us or not, you need to see this."
- ◆ Never call the buyer a liar. Let the data do it for you.

THE CLOSE

- ◆ "Hey, we need to catch up." — warm energy, friendly tone.
- ◆ "Just 5 to 10 minutes — I think you'll love it."
- ◆ Treat half an hour as \$5,000. Treat 5 minutes as 50¢. Ask in the right currency.

BUYERS ARE LIARS · IT'S NOT PERSONAL · GIVE THEM A SOFT WAY OUT